the Arab massacre of the Jewish population in Hebron, in 1929, where some sixty-seven Jews were killed and scores injured and maimed. The Arab attack was triggered by rumors that the Jews would take over the Temple Mount. The same rumors are periodically spread to this day.

Some other German Jews took up the coexistence dream (Hans Kohn, Martin Buber, Gershom Scholem, Ernst Simon) and established Ihud (Unity), a peace party that advocated a binational state. They represented the most prestigious names of the newly established Hebrew University and were strongly backed by its American-born rector, Judah Magnes. But it was a dream without a chance in the absence of any significant Palestinian response, the urge of the immense majority of the Yishuv (the Jewish community of Palestine) to fight, and Ben-Gurion's hard-knuckled realpolitik.

Not that I would have opposed militant politics when I boarded the *Altalena*, a ship belonging to Begin's Irgun, in June 1948. I was fifteen and wanted to fight. I did not fight on arrival, because my age—which I had hidden—was discovered, but my attitude stayed mainstream and hardline for many years. I did not particularly enjoy my three years in the army but my attitude did not shift leftward until the late 1960s or early 1970s. It is only then that I realized how determined the successive "socialist" governments were to push settlements and Israeli control over the Palestinians.

During the years spanning the creation of the State of Israel to the Six-Day War, only the extreme Israeli left went on promoting the idea of a binational state, a stand that, after 1967, became the more widely accepted —but still supported only by a minority—advocacy of the two-state solution. Today, this is fast turning into another empty dream: on the one hand, the relentless Israeli settlement policy, and on the other, the fierce "no compromise with the Jews" stand of Hamas, Islamic Jihad, and, behind them, Iran. Tragically, the "no compromise" stand is dominating social